



Nokia 7650

ceded from the race. Had it not been for their rivalry and urge to one-up each other, the mobile phone camera progress would have perhaps been a lot slower, and a lot less interesting.

Back in 2002, the Nokia 7650 was the first smartphone in the world to have a camera and was also Nokia's first camera phone. It had a measly VGA resolution sensor and things like flash and video recording were unheard of back then on phones. The first Sony Eric-

sson phone to have a camera was the T610 and it was only a CIF shooter. It was with the P900 that Sony Ericsson joined the prestigious VGA Resolution Club, along with the Smartphone with a Camera Club.

A year later, Nokia released the 3650 with the world's most confounding keypad arrangements. But other than that, the other interesting thing about it was that it was the first smartphone to be able to record videos. Granted they could only be 15 seconds long (this was to be able to send them over MMS that could only be 100KB in size at that time) and looked blurrier than the moon landing videos; after all, we were looking at a 176 x 144 resolution video. But it added another interesting dimension to mobile phone photography. Now you could shoot videos. Shoot terrible quality videos, but shoot them nonetheless.

But it took Sony Ericsson to release the first serious camera phone a year later; in fact, the first phone worthy of the title 'camera phone', which didn't exist as such back then. It was the K700i. If you owned one of these or used one of these, you'd know what we are talking about. We are still talking VGA resolution here, but this phone had a genuinely good cameras, with photos you'd want to take, want to store, want to see and want to share. This was the first legitimate camera phone that we can remember of.

Then Nokia decided to rain on Sony Ericsson's parade and launched the 7610. This was the first phone ever to have a 1 megapixel camera, or even